

The Value of Work

Meaning of Work

People perform many kinds of activities in daily life. These activities help individuals, families, and society.

Examples:

- **Pilots protect the country.**
 - **Shopkeepers sell goods.**
 - **Teachers educate students.**
 - **Family members help each other at home.**
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Types of Activities

Economic Activities

Activities done to earn money or money's worth are called economic activities.

Features

- **Involve payment or income**
- **Create monetary value**
- **Help in production or services**

Examples

- **Farmer selling crops**
- **Lawyer charging fees**
- **Driver transporting goods**
- **Factory workers making products**
- **Software engineer working in a company**

Forms of Payment

- **Salary – fixed monthly payment**
- **Wage – payment for specific work/time**
- **Fee – payment for professional services**
- **Payment in kind – payment through goods instead of cash**

Example: A labourer receiving mangoes as part of payment.

Non-Economic Activities

Activities done out of love, care, gratitude, or service without earning money are called non-economic activities.

Features

- **No income is earned**
- **Done voluntarily or for family/community welfare**
- **Improve social wellbeing**

Examples

- **Parents cooking for family**
 - **Helping grandparents**
 - **Teaching children for free**
 - **Community service**
 - **Volunteering in social programmes**
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Value Addition

When a person increases the usefulness or worth of something through skill and effort, it is called value addition.

Example

A carpenter buys wood for ₹600 and makes a chair sold for ₹1000.

Extra ₹400 = value added through:

- **Skill**
 - **Time**
 - **Labour**
 - **Creativity**
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4. Importance of Non-Economic Activities

Though they do not earn money, non-economic activities are very valuable because they:

- **Strengthen families and communities**
 - **Promote cooperation and kindness**
 - **Improve quality of life**
 - **Help society grow together**
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Sevā (Selfless Service)

Sevā means helping others without expecting anything in return.

Examples

- **Langars in gurudwaras**
- **Distributing prasad**
- **Community kitchens**
- **Voluntary teaching**

These activities create:

- **Social harmony**
 - **Compassion**
 - **Gratitude**
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Community Participation

People working together for society's welfare is called community participation.

Examples

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan

People clean streets, parks, and public places together.

Van Mahotsav

People plant trees and spread awareness about forests and conservation.

Importance

- **Builds unity**
- **Improves environment**

Encourages responsibility